Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 4 expectations

Grade 4 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 4 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.4.2, L.4.2a, L.4.2b, L.4.2c, L.4.2d

A worked example

Correct this sentence: hamdan asked "can we ride the metro to dubai mall"

1. Capitalise names of people and places: Hamdan, Dubai Mall.
2. Put a comma before the spoken words: asked, "...
3. Capitalise the first word of the speech: Can.
4. The speech is a question, so end it with a question mark inside the quotation marks.

Hamdan asked, "Can we ride the metro to Dubai Mall?"

Questions

1. Which is the correct way to write this book title?

   A. The Story Of The Golden Falcon
   B. The Story of the Golden Falcon
   C. the story of the golden falcon
   D. The story of the golden falcon

2. Which sentence uses capital letters correctly?

   A. My cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the Sea.
   B. My Cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the sea.
   C. My cousin Salem lives in abu dhabi near the sea.
   D. My cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the sea.

3. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

   A. "Let us visit the souq", said Dad.
   B. "Let us visit the souq." said Dad.
   C. "Let us visit the souq," said Dad.
   D. "Let us visit the souq," said dad.

4. Punctuate it: Maryam said please pass the dates

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5. Which sentence has the comma in the right place?

   A. Hamdan wanted to ride the metro, but the train was full.

   B. Hamdan wanted, to ride the metro but the train was full.

   C. Hamdan wanted to ride, the metro but the train was full.

   D. Hamdan wanted to ride the metro but, the train was full.

6. Which sentence needs a comma before "and"? A) Noura packed her bag and went to school. B) Noura packed her bag and her brother packed his.

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7. Which word completes the sentence correctly? The oryx is a ___ animal.

   A. beutiful

   B. beautifull

   C. beautiful

   D. beautyful

8. Which spelling completes the sentence? The mangrove trees grow in ___ water near the coast.

   A. shalow

   B. shallow

   C. shallo

   D. shallew

9. What is the plural of the word family?

   A. familys

   B. familyes

   C. familes

   D. families

10. Correct everything: layla asked can we visit al ain in winter

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11. Explain why Dad has a capital letter in A but dad does not in B. A) I asked Dad for help. B) I asked my dad for help.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.4.1a, L.4.1b, L.4.1c, L.4.1d, L.4.1e, L.4.1f, L.4.1g, L.4.3a, L.4.3c, L.4.4, L.4.4a, L.4.4b, L.4.4c, L.4.5, L.4.5a, L.4.5b, L.4.5c

A worked example

Choose the best word to finish the sentence: The girl ___ kite flew highest won a prize. (who / whose / which)

1. The missing word links the girl to the kite that belongs to her.
2. A word that shows belonging is needed, so choose whose.
3. Check by reading it aloud: The girl whose kite flew highest won a prize.

whose

Questions

1. Which word best completes the sentence? This is the beach ___ we found shells.

   A. where

   B. who

   C. whose

   D. which

2. Which word best completes the sentence? My uncle, ___ drives a bus, knows every road in Sharjah.

   A. where

   B. who

   C. whose

   D. which

3. Which choice completes the sentence with the past progressive? Salem ___ along the creek when it began to rain.

   A. walked

   B. is walking

   C. will be walking

   D. was walking

4. Write the future progressive form of "drive": Tomorrow at noon, we ___ to Al Ain.

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5. Which helping verb best completes the sentence? It is cloudy this morning, so it ___ rain later.

   A. has

   B. might

   C. need

   D. did

6. Choose the best helping verb (must, might, can): At the cycling track there is a rule: cyclists ___ wear a helmet.

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7. Which phrase has the adjectives in the right order?

   A. a big young brown camel

   B. a brown young big camel

   C. a young brown big camel

   D. a big brown young camel

8. Finish the sentence with a phrase that begins with a word like on, under or near: The falcon landed ___.

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9. Which group of words is a fragment?

   A. Omar ran across the sand.

   B. Running across the sand.

   C. The falcon flew home.

   D. Salem opened the door.

10. Fix this run-on sentence in two different ways: The metro was crowded Layla found a seat near the door.

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11. Which sentence uses to, too and two correctly?

    A. Hind has too cousins, and she wants to visit them to.

    B. Hind has to cousins, and she wants too visit them two.

    C. Hind has two cousins, and she wants to visit them too.

    D. Hind has two cousins, and she wants too visit them to.

12. Replace "said" with a more exact word: "Look out!" said Salem. Then explain why your word is better.

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13. Which of these two sentences suits a note to the head teacher, and why? A) Hey, we're gonna be late. B) We will arrive a few minutes late, and we are sorry.

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14. What does "parched" mean in this sentence? After the long walk, the camels were parched, so Khalid gave them water and they drank deeply.

    A. very tired

    B. very hungry

    C. very hot

    D. very dry and thirsty

15. Which reference book would you use to check the meaning of a word, and which would you use to find another word with a similar meaning?

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16. Many English words are built from Greek and Latin roots. The Latin root "port" means "carry". The Greek root "tele" means "far" and "scope" means "to look at". What do the words portable and telescope mean?

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17. Name the kind of figurative language in each sentence and say what it means. A) The desert sand was a golden blanket. B) Hamdan ran as fast as a falcon. C) The maths quiz was a piece of cake.

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18. Which word means almost the same as "enormous"?

    A. huge

    B. tiny

    C. ordinary

    D. narrow

19. Say in your own words what this proverb means: Many hands make light work.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.4.1, W.4.2, W.4.3, W.4.4, W.4.5, W.4.7, W.4.9, W.4.10, SL.4.1, SL.4.2, SL.4.3, SL.4.4, SL.4.6

A worked example

Put these sentences in order to make instructions for planting a tree: A) Then water it every day. B) First, dig a small hole in the soil. C) Finally, watch it grow. D) Next, place the seedling in the hole.

1. Look for the order words: First, Next, Then, Finally.
2. First comes B (dig the hole), because you cannot plant before there is a hole.
3. Next comes D (place the seedling), then A (water it), and Finally C (watch it grow).

B, D, A, C

Questions

1. Which order puts these sentences into a short story? A) At last, she found the key under the cushion. B) One evening, Noura could not find her house key. C) She searched the hall, the kitchen and her bag. D) She smiled and put it safely on its hook.

   A. A, B, C, D

   B. B, A, C, D

   C. B, C, A, D

   D. C, B, A, D

2. Write one sentence that states your opinion on this question: Should every classroom have a reading corner?

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3. Make a plan for an opinion paragraph: "Every classroom should have a plant." Write your opinion, two reasons and one example for each reason.

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4. Which sentence does not belong in a paragraph about falcons?

   A. Falcons have sharp eyesight.

   B. Falcons can fly very fast.

   C. Falcons hunt from the sky.

   D. My cousin has a red bicycle.

5. Which linking phrase best completes the paragraph? Mangroves protect the coast. ___, they give young fish a safe place to grow.

   A. Suddenly

   B. However

   C. In addition

   D. Instead

6. Join the two sentences with a linking word: Camels store fat in their humps. They can travel far without food.

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7. Which opening is better for a story?

   A. One morning, Hind heard a tapping sound from the garden wall.

   B. There was a girl.

   C. This story is about a girl.

   D. A girl lived somewhere.

8. Revise this sentence by adding at least two details: The boat went on the creek.

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9. Write a concluding sentence for this paragraph: The Dubai Metro is fast and clean. Passengers can reach many parts of the city without sitting in traffic. Trains arrive every few minutes.

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10. Edit this paragraph (there are several mistakes): yesterday we visit the date farm. we picked many dates they was sweet.

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11. Plan a short story called "A Trip to the Hajar Mountains" with a family. Write one sentence for the beginning, one for the middle and one for the end.

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12. Why does it help to make a plan before you write a story? Give one reason.

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13. Speaking and listening (parent task). First read a short book or article about the Hope Probe together (one chosen by an adult). Then say to your child: "Let us talk about what we read. We will take turns. I will tell you one thing I found interesting, and you ask me a question about it. Then you tell me one thing, and I will ask you a question about it. Let us keep to the topic and not interrupt each other." Do three turns each.

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14. Listening, part one (parent task). Read this talk aloud once, calmly and clearly: "We should plant mangroves near our beach. Mangrove roots hold the sand, so the shore does not wash away. Young fish hide in the roots, so there are more fish for fishers. The trees also give shade to visitors." Then say: "Tell me in your own words what this talk was about."

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15. Listening, part two (parent task). Read Salem's talk aloud again. Then ask: "What does Salem want? Give me two reasons he gives."

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16. Speaking (parent task). Say to your child: "Please give me a talk of about one minute called My Favourite Place in the UAE. Pretend you are speaking to your class, so use formal English, for example I would like to tell you about ... Include two or three facts, and speak clearly at a steady pace." Listen without interrupting.

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17. Research (parent task, with an adult). Choose one UAE animal, such as the oryx, the camel or the falcon. Find four facts from two sources, such as a library book and, if an adult sits with you, a trusted website (the website is optional). Write a short report of three or four sentences in your own words and say where each fact came from.

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18. Write two sentences about the same animal as a note for a younger child. Use simple words and a friendly tone.

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19. Read this paragraph: "The Arabian oryx is a pale antelope with long straight horns. Its light coat reflects the heat of the sun. It can live for a long time without drinking, because it gets water from the plants it eats." Write three sentences that answer: Why is the oryx well suited to desert life? Use at least two facts from the paragraph as evidence.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. B. The Story of the Golden Falcon. The first word and the important words have capitals, but small words like of and the in the middle do not.
2. D. My cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the sea. Names of people and places have capitals; sea is a general word.
3. C. "Let us visit the souq," said Dad. The comma goes inside the quotation marks, and Dad is used as a name so it has a capital letter.
4. Maryam said, "Please pass the dates."
5. A. Hamdan wanted to ride the metro, but the train was full. A comma goes before the joining word (but) in a sentence made of two complete parts.
6. B needs a comma before "and" (Noura packed her bag, and her brother packed his.). In A, "and" joins two actions by the same person, so no comma is needed.
7. C. beautiful. The correct spelling is beautiful.
8. B. shallow. The correct spelling is shallow (two l's).
9. D. families. Change the y to i and add es: families.
10. Layla asked, "Can we visit Al Ain in winter?"
11. In A, Dad is used as a name (it stands in for the person's name), so it takes a capital letter. In B, my dad is a general word for a family member, with my in front of it, so it does not.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. A. where. Where tells the place.
2. B. who. Who refers to a person.
3. D. was walking. Was walking is the past progressive form.
4. will be driving
5. B. might. Might shows the rain is possible, not certain.
6. must (it shows a rule that has to be followed)
7. A. a big young brown camel. The order is size, then age, then colour.
8. Answers vary. Example: The falcon landed on Khalid's glove. (The phrase must begin with a word such as on, under or near and tell where.)
9. B. Running across the sand. "Running across the sand" has no complete action by someone, so it is a fragment.
10. Example 1: The metro was crowded. Layla found a seat near the door. Example 2: The metro was crowded, but Layla found a seat near the door.
11. C. Hind has two cousins, and she wants to visit them too. Two is the number, to goes before visit, and too means also.
12. Example: "Look out!" shouted Salem (shouted shows how loudly he spoke; warned also works). A good answer gives an exact word and says what it shows that "said" does not.
13. B. It uses polite, formal English, which suits a note to a head teacher. A is casual and suits talking with friends.
14. D. very dry and thirsty. The clue is that the camels needed water and drank deeply.

15. A dictionary (or glossary) gives the meaning of a word; a thesaurus gives words with a similar meaning.
16. Portable means able to be carried. A telescope is an instrument for looking at things that are far away.
17. A is a metaphor (the sand is described as being a blanket: it lies smooth and covers the ground). B is a simile (it compares using "as ... as": Hamdan ran very fast). C is an idiom (the quiz was very easy; it does not mean real cake).
18. A. huge. Enormous and huge both mean very big.
19. When many people share a job, it is easier and quicker to finish.

Section 3: Writing

1. C. B, C, A, D. B is the beginning, C the middle, A the solution and D the ending.
2. A good answer states a clear opinion in a complete sentence. Example: I believe every classroom should have a reading corner because it makes reading feel welcoming.
3. A good plan has the opinion, two different reasons, and an example for each. Example: Reason 1: plants make the air feel fresher (example: the aloe plant by the window). Reason 2: caring for a plant teaches responsibility (example: a pupil waters it each Monday).
4. D. My cousin has a red bicycle. The sentence about the bicycle is not about falcons.
5. C. In addition. In addition adds a second fact.
6. Example: Camels store fat in their humps, so they can travel far without food. (Because also works if the order is changed.)
7. A. One morning, Hind heard a tapping sound from the garden wall. It names a person, a time and something interesting that makes the reader want to know more.
8. Answers vary. Example: The small wooden boat drifted gently along the quiet creek at sunrise.
9. A good answer sums up the main idea and does not add a new topic. Example: This is why the metro is a good choice for travelling around the city.
10. Yesterday we visited the date farm. We picked many dates. They were sweet. (capital letters, past tense visited, full stops to separate the sentences, were not was)
11. A good answer has three sentences: a beginning that sets the scene, a middle with a problem or an exciting event, and an end that solves it. Answers will vary.
12. Any sensible reason, for example: the ideas are in order before writing, so the story is clear and stays on the topic.
13. Listen for: the child has read the text first, takes turns, listens without interrupting, asks questions linked to what was just said (for example: Why do you say that? What did you think of ...?), adds ideas that stay on the topic, and speaks politely. Finish with one specific thing the child did well.
14. A good retell keeps the main ideas in the child's own words and in order: the speaker wants mangroves planted near the beach, and gives reasons about the sand, the fish and the shade. It does not need to repeat the exact words.
15. Salem wants mangroves planted near the beach. Any two reasons: the roots hold the sand so the shore stays in place; young fish hide in the roots so there are more fish for fishers; the trees give shade to visitors.

16. A good talk has an opening that names the place, two or three facts in a sensible order, a closing sentence, a clear voice at a steady pace, and complete sentences in formal English. Give kind, specific feedback on one thing done well and one thing to try next time.
17. A good answer shows four facts from two sources, written in the child's own words (not copied), with each source named (for example the book title). The facts must be true for the animal chosen.
18. A good answer is two complete sentences with simple words, a friendly tone, and true facts, showing that writing changes for a younger reader. Example: The oryx is a pale, strong animal. It can live in the hot desert for a long time without a drink!
19. A good answer is in the child's own words and uses the paragraph: the pale coat reflects the sun's heat, and the oryx gets water from plants so it can go a long time without drinking. Example: The oryx is well suited to the desert. Its light coat reflects the heat of the sun. Also, it gets water from the plants it eats, so it does not need to drink often.